

NICHOLAS MAJOR

Researcher · M.S. in Psychology

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Mixed-methods researcher with 4+ years designing and running human-subjects studies, including usability testing, controlled experiments, and large-scale surveys, and translating findings into design and product recommendations. Experienced collaborating with engineers and cross-functional teams and communicating insights to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS

- **UX & Research Methods:** Usability testing, experimental design, A/B testing, survey design, mixed-methods analysis, participant recruitment, prototype evaluation, think-aloud protocols
- **Data & Analysis:** Python, R, SPSS, JASP, statistical modeling, quantitative & qualitative analysis
- **Tools:** Qualtrics, Prolific, Figma, PsychoPy, GitHub, Trello, Microsoft Office, SQL
- **Languages:** English (native), Spanish (intermediate)

RESEARCH & UX EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher | Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA Aug 2024 – Aug 2025
M.S. Thesis: Gamification & Creativity

- Designed and led an end-to-end experimental study comparing user performance and engagement in a gamified vs. non-gamified cognitive task; gamified design produced 30% faster task outcomes
- Built interactive study tasks in Python to test hypotheses about motivation, engagement, and creativity
- Owned participant recruitment and lab sessions; trained and supervised a team of research assistants
- Analyzed behavioral data in JASP and translated results into actionable design implications for engagement-driven product experiences

Lab Manager | Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA Sep 2022 – Sep 2024
Human-Centered Cyber-Physical Security Project

- Partnered with engineers and computer scientists to study how users perceive and respond to cybersecurity risks, informing security-interface design decisions
- Co-developed survey materials and helped field large-scale studies via Qualtrics and Prolific; contributed to team-based data analysis
- Helped develop behavioral experiments probing real-world password habits to understand user security behavior
- Mentored student researchers in Qualtrics and PsychoPy; presented findings at a research conference

Research Assistant | Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA Jan 2021 – May 2022; Aug 2024 – Aug 2025
Cognitive Control Lab & Nano | Human Interface Initiative

- Coded video recordings of Microsoft HoloLens (AR) usability sessions, time-stamping moments of user difficulty to surface interaction pain points
- Helped develop a Python-based experimental prototype simulating a real-world microscopy workflow for expert users
- Ran study operations end to end: IRB submissions, participant scheduling, and data collection
- Co-authored a research manuscript (in prep) and presented findings at a research conference

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Independent Game Developer | Solo project Sep 2025 – Present

- Designing and developing a video game solo: game systems, code, art, music, and writing
- Running iterative playtesting cycles, gathering player feedback to identify friction points and refine mechanics, difficulty, and onboarding; applied usability practice

EDUCATION

M.S., Psychology, GPA: 3.87 | Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA 2025
B.S., Psychology, GPA: 3.93, summa cum laude | Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA 2022
A.A., Liberal Arts, Psychology, GPA: 3.98, summa cum laude | Northampton Community College 2017

PUBLICATION

- Braun, D., Major, N., Marvel, C., Spencer, E., & Arrington, C. (in prep.). Visual search in materials science: Experimental analog of a grain boundary detection task.